Vanguard Studios

The Default Cold-Call Script

Gatekeeper → Owner opener → Discovery → Price → Booked demo → Closer handoff

One script for every setter, built from the approved lines in all eight Vanguard sales skills. Say it word for word until it's memorised, then say it in your own voice. Fill **[brackets]** only with details you have verified are true. If you can't verify a detail, use the fallback: “no website, just the Google listing.”

#	Section	Page focus
1	Ground rules and off-limits lines	What never changes
2	Before you dial	Pre-shift, pre-dial, calling windows
3	Stage 1: Gatekeeper	Openers, 10 smokescreens, exit lines
4	Stage 2: Owner opener	The first 10 seconds
5	Stage 3: Discovery and rapport	2 or 3 questions, mirror, label
6	Stage 4: The price question	Two-ask rule, approved numbers
7	Stage 5: Booking	Two options, up-front contract, link
8	Quick saves	Any stage, including “don't call me”
9	Voicemail and follow-up	Voicemails, cadence, emails
10	After the call	Post-call checklist, GHL handoff note
11	For the Closer: the demo call	CLOSER agenda and objection loops
12	Variant: AI automation offer	Same script, different hook
13	Daily practice and scoring	30-minute routine, scorecard, hard fails

1 · Ground rules

Source: vanguard-setter-coach, vanguard-gatekeeper, vanguard-cold-call-opener

Your job is to **book a qualified 15-minute demo** with [Closer] of a website Vanguard has **already built** for the business. You don't sell the website, quote a final price or set terms.

Non-negotiables, every call

- **Honesty.** Say your name and “Vanguard” in the first sentence. Never claim a relationship, referral or past call that didn't happen.
- **The demo exists.** It must be built before you dial, because “We already built it” has to be true.
- **Compliance.** Dial only DNC-checked numbers. Call only 8am–9pm **their** local time. Text only after a clear verbal yes.
- **“Don't call me.”** Apologise, end the call, add them to the do-not-call list the same day.
- **Logging.** Log every call in GHL the same day, with yourself as Setter Assigned.

Never say these (automatic fail)

✖ “I'm returning their call” · “They're expecting me” · “We spoke last week”

✖ “It's personal” · “It's about your account” · “It's urgent”

✖ “I'm calling about your Google listing”, or anything that sounds like you're Google

✖ Pretending to be a customer, supplier or friend · a made-up referral · “How have you been?” to a stranger

✖ Any price other than the approved ones · “It's cheap” · discounts, specials, “only two spots left”

✖ Promised results: “You'll rank #1”, “You'll get 20 more customers”

✖ Unverified compliments (“love your 5-star reviews” when they have 3.8) · trashing Wix, freelancers or the nephew

✖ Sending the demo link to the gatekeeper to “pass along” · texting without a yes

If anyone, including a famous trainer, tells you to use one of these: Vanguard doesn't. It's dishonest, and it burns the business for the next setter. Use the honest line from this script instead.

2 · Before you dial

Source: vanguard-setter-coach, vanguard-gatekeeper, web-design-agency-sales

Pre-shift (5 minutes)

- ☐ Opener out loud 3 times: under 10 seconds, statements ending on a down note
- ☐ Today's niches checked against the calling windows below
- ☐ Price lines memorised (page: Stage 4)
- ☐ [Closer]'s open slots for the next 3 days in front of you
- ☐ GHL open and ready to log
- ☐ Stand up, smile, reset your mood between calls

Pre-dial (every number)

- ☐ Number is DNC-checked
- ☐ It's 8am–9pm **in their time zone**, and inside the niche's window

- ☐ The demo site for this business exists and works on a phone; you have the link
- ☐ You have one **verified** true detail (review theme, no website, hours)
- ☐ Owner's name, if known
- ☐ You're ready to say your name and Vanguard in the first sentence

When to call (their local time)

Niche	Who usually answers	Best window
Salon / barber	Front desk, or a stylist between clients	Just after opening, or 2–4pm Tue–Thu. Never Saturday.
Trades / cleaners	Spouse or office manager (treat them as an influencer)	First thing, lunch, or after 5
Restaurants	Host or a manager mid-service	2–4pm. Never during lunch or dinner service.
Gyms / martial arts	Front desk or a coach	10am–2pm. Never 5–8am or 4–8pm class blocks.
Auto repair / towing	Service writer or dispatcher	At opening, the mid-afternoon lull, or near close
Daycare	Director or staff	Early-afternoon nap time

3 · Stage 1: Gatekeeper

Source: vanguard-gatekeeper (Module 01)

Skip this stage if the owner answers. **Mindset: ask for help, not access.** Talk slower than feels natural, let statements go down at the end, say one or two sentences, then stop. Answer *who* and *why* in one breath.

Pick one opener

Situation	Say
Owner's name known (default)	“Hi, this is [Your name] with Vanguard. Is [Owner] around?”
Owner's name unknown	“Hi, I'm hoping you can help me out. [Your name] with Vanguard. Who's the owner there?”
Sharp or suspicious answerer	“I'll be straight with you, this is a sales call. We already built a demo website for [Business], and I'm trying to get 15 minutes with the owner to show it to them. Is [Owner] in today?”
Busy counter (salon, barber, auto)	“Hey, sounds busy over there, I'll be quick. Is [Owner] free between clients at all today?”

The 10 smokescreens

Formula: **ledge (“Totally fair”) → one honest sentence → small ask**, all in one breath.

They say	You say
What's this regarding?	“Good question. We built a free demo website for [Business], and I wanted to show it to [Owner]. Are they in?”
Are they expecting your call?	“No, they're not. This is a cold call, I'll be honest. Is there a better time to catch them?”
They're busy / with a client / on a job.	“No problem, I figured. Are they easier to catch between clients, or after they're off the job site?”
Send us an email.	“Happy to. What's [Owner]'s best email? And when should I follow up by phone after they've had a look?”
We're not interested.	“Totally fair. Is website stuff [Owner]'s call? When's a good time for two minutes? If they say no, I'll leave you alone.”
We already have someone for that.	“Oh nice, who handles it? We built a version that fixes [verified gap]. [Owner] can compare in 15 minutes.” (No verified gap? Drop that clause.)
Can I take a message?	“Yes, please. [Your name] from Vanguard, we built a free demo website for [Business], my number's [number]. When should I try them back?”
Who are you with?	“Vanguard. We're a small web design company for local businesses. Is [Owner] around?”
They don't take sales calls.	“That's fair, I'd probably screen this too. It's already built, though. How do they like to see stuff like this?”
Just tell me and I'll pass it on.	“I appreciate that. I'd rather walk them through it myself so they get the full picture. When's a good time to reach them?”

Two-pushback rule and exit

After **two** pushbacks on one call, stop pushing. Get a callback time or leave a message. Leave every call with **three things**: the owner's name, the gatekeeper's name and a specific callback time.

> “Thanks, [Gatekeeper]. I'll try [Owner] at [time].”
>
> Then call at **exactly** that time.

4 · Stage 2: Owner opener

Source: vanguard-cold-call-opener (Module 02)

Goal: earn the next 30 seconds. Under 10 seconds (25 words or fewer), slow and low, then stop and let them answer.

DEFAULT OPENER

"[Owner], this is [Your name] with Vanguard. I'll be honest, this is a cold call. Can I take 30 seconds to tell you why I called, and then you tell me if it's worth keeping going?"

[Stop. Wait for their answer.]

Reason + demo hook: "I found [Business] on Google, [verified detail], but there's no website, just the listing. So we built you a demo. It's done. I'd love to show it to you."

Alternate openers

Use when	Say
Reviews show a clear, verified theme	"The reason I'm calling: I was reading your Google reviews. People keep mentioning [real theme]. But when someone searches you, there's no website to land on. So we built one."
Guarded owner, or a niche hammered by agency calls	"You probably get a lot of calls from website people, so I'll keep this short and different. We didn't call to pitch you. We already built a demo site for [Business]. All I'd like is 15 minutes to show it to you. Fair?"
You hear a job site, truck or busy floor	"I know I'm probably catching you on a job, so I'll be quick. We built a free demo website for [Business]. Can I grab 15 minutes, early morning or after you're off site?"

Why a permission-based opener

Gong's analysis of cold calls found a permission-based opener booked meetings at 11.18%, "How's your day going?" at 7.6%, and "Did I catch you at a bad time?" at 2.15%. Stating a clear reason for the call roughly doubled success. These were mostly B2B calls, so treat the numbers as direction, not a promise.

Delivery

- **Slow and low.** Fast sounds like a pitch. Statements end on a down note.
- **Stand up and smile.** People hear it.
- **Say it in your own words** once memorised. A script that sounds like a robot loses.
- Don't pitch features in the first 15 seconds. Don't back off "Is now a good time?" with "Oh, sorry."

5 · Stage 3: Discovery and rapport

Source: vanguard-cold-call-opener, vanguard-price-question

Ask **two or three** light questions, not seven in a row. Listen more than you talk.

Question	Why it matters
"Are you the one who makes the call on stuff like this?"	[Closer] needs the decision-maker on the demo.
"How do most new customers find you right now?"	Every answer gives [Closer] something to work with. Log their exact words.
"When someone Googles you, what do they find?"	Lets them say the gap out loud.
"Are you taking on new customers right now?"	Booked-solid owners are a weaker fit.

Rapport tools

- **One true detail.** One verified detail beats three generic compliments.
- **Mirror.** Repeat their last 1–3 words as a question, then go quiet: “Mostly Facebook?”
- **Label.** “Sounds like you're slammed.” “Seems like word of mouth has been good to you.” Then pause.
- **Match energy.** Clipped roofer: be shorter. Chatty salon owner: slow down. Stressed owner: calmer and lower.
- **Names.** Use their name at the start and once before the booking ask. Use the title they go by: Coach, Doc, Chef.

6 · Stage 4: “What does it cost?”

Source: vanguard-price-question (Module 03)

The rule: if they had to ask twice, they get the number. Never make them ask a third time. “How much?” is a question, not an objection. Answer it.

THE FOUR STEPS

1 · Acknowledge. “Fair question, and I'll give you a straight answer.”

2 · It depends + ONE fit question. “It depends on what you need. A 5-page site is different from one with booking. Quick one so I'm not guessing: are people mostly calling you right now, or booking online?”

3 · Second ask: ballpark, then pause. “Most of our builds land around two thousand, one-time, and the demo itself is free.” *[Stay silent for two seconds.]*

4 · Bridge. “The exact number depends on what you need, and that's what [Closer] works out when they show you the demo. 15 minutes. Is Tuesday or Thursday better?”

If they ask twice before your fit question lands, skip straight to step 3. The rule beats the script.

Approved numbers: the only ones you may say

Topic	Say exactly
Typical build	“Most of our builds land around two thousand, one-time.”
Bigger build (booking + gallery)	“Around twenty-six hundred.”
Monthly?	“The build is one-time. There's an optional care plan, about two hundred a month, cancel anytime.”
The demo	“Free. No card, no contract.”
Timeline	“Live 14 days after your kick-off call.” Never “14 days from today.”
Discounts, payment plans, terms	“I can't set prices or terms. That's [Closer]'s call, and I won't guess.”

Follow-ups after the ballpark

They say	You say
That's too expensive.	“Yeah, it's not a small number. What were you expecting?” … “Worst case, you see a free demo and decide it's not for you.”
I can get Wix for $20 a month.	“You can, and for some businesses that's right. The difference is who does the work. If both cost the same, would you rather build it yourself or have it done?”
My nephew does websites.	“That's great. Is he building it now, or is it more of a 'one day' thing?”
Just email me the price.	“I'll save you the wait: most builds land around two thousand, one-time. I'll email the demo now. What's the best address?”
Is the demo really free? What's the catch?	“Really free. The honest catch: we hope you like it enough to have us make it your real site. If not, you've lost 15 minutes.”

The $300 rule: don't book a non-fit

“If it was right, is around two thousand in the range you'd consider?”

If their ceiling is far below (e.g. “$300 max”): “Honestly, that's below where our builds land, so I don't want to waste your 15 minutes. Can I email you the demo anyway so you have it?” Log it as not a fit, with the budget they gave.

7 · Stage 5: Booking

Source: vanguard-cold-call-opener, vanguard-price-question, vanguard-setter-coach

BOOK IT

1 · Tie the demo to their words. “You said [their words]. That's exactly what the demo fixes. 15 minutes with the person who'd build it. No obligation.”

2 · Two options, then stop talking. “[Owner], does Tuesday or Wednesday work better?”

3 · Up-front contract. “So here's how the call works. 15 to 30 minutes with [Closer]. They show you the demo, ask a few questions, and give you an exact price. If it's not for you, just say so. Fair?”

4 · Send the link now. “Can I text you the link?” Text only after a clear yes, otherwise email. Then: “Did that come through?”

8 · Quick saves (any stage)

Source: vanguard-cold-call-opener, vanguard-setter-coach

They say	You say
Who is this?	“It's [Your name] with Vanguard. We build websites for local businesses, and we already built a demo site for [Business].”
How did you get my number?	“Fair question. Your business number is listed on Google. I was looking up [niche] in [city] and came across you.”
Is this a scam? Are you Google?	“No, and I'm glad you asked. We're not Google. I'm happy to send the demo link so you can look before you agree to anything.”
Bad time.	“No problem at all. 20 minutes from now, or after 5?” Then call at exactly that time.
Don't call me.	“Understood, I'm sorry for the interruption. I'll take you off our list today.” End the call. Add them to DNC today. Don't argue.

9 · Voicemail and follow-up

Source: web-design-agency-sales (outreach sequence)

Voicemails (under 25 seconds)

VM #1: “Hi [Name], this is [Your name] with Vanguard. We build websites for local businesses, and we already built a demo site for [Business]. I'd love 15 minutes to show it to you. My number is [number], again [number]. Thanks.”

VM #2: “Hi [Name], [Your name] from Vanguard again. The demo we built for [Business] uses a few of your Google reviews, the ones about [true theme]. Happy to walk you through it whenever's easy. [number].”

Cadence (example; adjust to your capacity)

Day	Touch	Notes
1	Call + VM #1	At the niche's best window. Gatekeeper: get the three things.
2	Email #1	Only to a verified business email
3	Call at the agreed callback time	Exact time, no drift
5	Call	Different time window
7	Email #2	New angle: one thing in the demo built from their reviews
10	Call + VM #2	
14	Email #3 (breakup)	Polite close, door open

Any reply on any channel stops the sequence. Every email has your real name and company, an accurate subject, a physical postal address and a one-line opt-out (“Not interested? Reply ‘no’ and I won't email again.”). Check current CAN-SPAM, CASL or GDPR rules for the recipient's location.

Email #1 (plain text)

Subject: demo for [business]

Hi [Name], I was looking at [Business] on Google. [True detail.] There's no website though, just the listing. So we built a demo site for you. It's done, and it's yours to look at with no strings. Worth a 15-minute look this week?

[Your name], Vanguard Studios · [phone] · [postal address] · Not interested? Reply “no” and I won't email again.

10 · After the call

Source: vanguard-setter-coach, vanguard-price-question

- ☐ Logged in GHL the same day, with yourself as Setter Assigned
- ☐ Owner's name, gatekeeper's name and exact callback time recorded
- ☐ Callback reminder set for **exactly** that time
- ☐ Any “don't call me” added to DNC today
- ☐ Link sent by text only after a clear yes, otherwise by email

GHL handoff note (write what they actually said)

SETTER HANDOFF: [Business] · Setter: [name] · Closer: [Closer]

Booked: [day, date, time, owner's local time] · Link sent: [text after yes / email] · Received? [Y/N]

Decision-maker: spoke with [name, role] · who decides [owner / + spouse / partner] · on the call? [Y/N]

How customers find them (their words): “[quote]”

Price signal: asked? [Y/N] · answered on ask # [1/2] · ballpark given [~$2,000 / ~$2,600 / care plan] · reaction “[quote]” · number they named [$ / none]

Fit: taking new customers? [Y/N] · current site [none / URL] · interest in booking, gallery, care plan [notes]

Objections (their words): “[quote]” → approved line used

Up-front contract set? [Y/N] · **Notes for Closer:** review themes, timing, who answers the phone

Didn't book? Log it anyway with the outcome (not a fit – budget, callback time, demo emailed, do-not-call).

11 · For the Closer: the demo call

Source: sales-team-manager (CLOSER framework), web-design-agency-sales, hormozi-offer-builder

Setters don't use this page. Only [Closer] sets the exact price, payment terms, guarantees and bonuses.

Pre-call prep (5 minutes, from the GHL handoff)

Owner's name and title · who else decides · how customers find them · price reaction on the setter call · the true detail from the opener · demo link opened and tested on a phone.

CLOSER agenda (example: 25 minutes)

Min	Step	What to say / do
0–3	**C**larify why they're here	“[Setter] mentioned you agreed to take a look at the demo. What made you say yes?” Then the up-front contract: “I'll show you the demo, ask a few questions, and give you an exact price. If it's not for you, just say so. Fair?”
3–5	**L**abel the problem	“So right now people find you on Google, but there's no site to land on, and some of them may call the next shop. Is that right?” Wait for the yes.
5–8	**O**verview past pain	“Have you had a website before, or tried Wix, or someone building one? What happened with that?”
8–16	**S**ell the vacation, then the demo	“Picture someone searching [service] in [city] at 9pm. They find you, see your work, your reviews, and book or call.” Then walk the demo on their phone, tying each page to their words. No promised results.
16–18	Exact price	Give the number and what's included: one-time build, optional care plan. Then stop talking.
18–23	**E**xplain away concerns	“What questions do you have for me?” Isolate: “Other than [concern], is there anything else?” Then answer with real proof.
23–25	**R**einforce the decision	“Want us to make this your real site?” On yes: agreement and invoice on the call, kick-off booked before you hang up. Live 14 days after kick-off.

The three buying conditions

Almost every objection means one of three is missing: **they believe it will work**, **they trust you**, **they can afford it**. Ask: “Let's figure this out together. Is it more about whether it'll work, about us, or about the money?”

Objection loops (honest versions)

They say	Closer says
It's too much.	“It's not a small number. Is it the total, or the timing of paying it?” Offer only real options (smaller scope, a payment plan if the company has one). Never invent a discount.
I need to talk to my partner.	“Makes sense. What do you think they'll say?” If positive: “Want to grab them for two minutes now, or set a quick three-way call?”
I need to think about it.	“Totally fair. What specifically do you want to think through: whether it'll work, the price, or the timing?” Address that one thing, then set a specific follow-up date.
How do I know this works?	Acknowledge past bad experiences. Show real client sites and real reviews. Explain any guarantee exactly as written; never improvise one.

Offer rules (from the offer builder)

- Scarcity and urgency only if real (a true capacity cap, a real price change on a real date). No fake deadlines.
- Guarantee only what Vanguard controls (speed, revisions, responsiveness), never rankings or customer counts.
- Bonus values must be what you'd actually charge for them. No invented stats or testimonials.

12 · Variant: selling an AI automation

Source: ai-automation-agency-sales

Same script, same rules, different hook. Use it only if a demo of the automation has actually been built for this business using its real, public info (hours, services, FAQ).

Script line	Website version	AI automation version
Demo hook	“We built you a demo. It's done.”	“We already built a demo of an after-hours receptionist for [Business]. It's done. I'd love 15 minutes to show you.”
Gatekeeper reason	“We built a free demo website for [Business].”	“We built a short demo of an assistant that answers [Business]'s missed calls.”
Email true detail	“There's no website, just the listing.”	“I called [Business] [true observation, e.g. Tuesday evening] and got voicemail.” Only if you actually did.
Price	Approved website numbers	Use the agency's own setup + monthly rates. Never invent a price.

- The demo agent identifies itself as an automated assistant for [Business]. Never clone the owner's or staff's voice.
- On a discovery call, any ROI math uses **only the prospect's own numbers**, shown as a range with the conservative case first.
- No industry statistics or guaranteed results. Flag recording consent, text consent and SMS registration as “check current law.”

13 · Daily practice and scoring

Source: vanguard-setter-coach, sales-team-manager

The 30-minute daily routine (first two weeks)

Block	Drill	Pass looks like
~8 min	Opener out loud, 10 reps	25 words or fewer, name + Vanguard, “this is a cold call”, permission ask, then silence
~8 min	Smokescreen rapid-fire, 10 reps, random order	Ledge → one honest sentence → small ask, in one breath
~6 min	Two-ask price drill, 5 rounds	“It depends” + one fit question, then the approved ballpark on the second ask, pause, bridge
~8 min	One full cold-call role-play	Gatekeeper → opener → discovery → price → booked with two options and the link confirmed

Managers: run role-play as **interrupt-and-redo**. Stop the rep at the mistake, model the better line, have them repeat it, continue. Weekly, review three recorded calls (one booked, one hang-up, one “send me info”) and find the exact second each one turned.

100-point call scorecard

Section	Points	What earns them
Gatekeeper	20	Who + why in one breath, right opener, ledge → sentence → ask, two-pushback rule, three things
Opener and rapport	25	Under 10 seconds, clear reason + demo hook, one verified detail, mirror/label, no early pitch
Discovery and fit	15	2–3 questions, decision-maker confirmed, usable notes, no non-fits booked
Price handling	20	Honest acknowledgement, one fit question, ballpark by the second ask, pause, bridge
Booking and close-out	15	Demo tied to their words, two options, up-front contract, link sent and confirmed
Delivery	5	Short sentences, statements end down, silence after asks, sounds natural

Hard fails override the score: any off-limits line, any unapproved price, a missing name or Vanguard in the first sentence, a text without a verbal yes, or ignoring “don't call me.” Bands: 90–100 certified · 75–89 solid, fix one item · 60–74 daily drills on the weakest section · under 60 back to drills before live dials.

Where each part came from

Skill	Used for
vanguard-setter-coach	Ground rules, checklists, practice routine, scorecard
vanguard-gatekeeper	Stage 1: openers, smokescreens, timing, three things
vanguard-cold-call-opener	Stage 2–3: openers, delivery, rapport, quick saves
vanguard-price-question	Stage 4: two-ask rule, approved numbers, follow-ups, fit, handoff note
web-design-agency-sales	Voicemails, cadence, emails, Closer pre-call prep
sales-team-manager	CLOSER demo-call framework, objection loops, interrupt-and-redo training
hormozi-offer-builder	Offer rules for the Closer: real scarcity, honest guarantees, defensible bonuses
ai-automation-agency-sales	Section 12: the AI automation variant